Vibe coding workshop

2-hour session plan · 4 teams of 5

Setup (before the session starts)

- ☐ Everyone has access to an AI coding tool — Claude.ai in a browser tab, or GitHub Copilot in VS Code
- ☐ Everyone has a place to write and run code: StackBlitz "Static" template (zero install), or a local folder with index.html / style.css / script.js opened in VS Code with Live Server
- ☐ Teams are pre-assigned (below) so Phase 1 goes straight to spec-writing instead of debating an app choice

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Team assignments

Team	App
1	Flashcard quiz — add cards, flip to reveal the answer, shuffle
2	Habit tracker — mark days done on a weekly grid, streak counter
3	Recipe box — add/search/delete recipes with an ingredients list
4	Expense tracker — add expenses, category totals, running balance

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Roles for a 5-person team

Two roles stay fixed for the whole session. The other three rotate at 0:40 and 1:10 so every member gets hands-on prompting time.

Role	Type	Job
Scribe	Fixed	Logs every prompt sent and its outcome — feeds directly into the Phase 5 reflection
Timekeeper	Fixed	Watches the clock, calls out time before each checkpoint, is the one person allowed to say "stop, move on"
Prompter	Rotates	Writes and sends the prompts

Reviewer	Rotates	Reads every AI response before it's pasted in, flags anything nobody understands
Tester	Rotates	Runs the app after every change, actively tries to break it

Session timeline

Plan	Scaffold	Build	Test	Polish	Demo
0–25 min	25–40 min	40–90 min	90–105 min	105–113 min	113–120 min

Task list by phase

Phase 1 — Plan before you prompt (0:00–0:25)

- ☐ Write a 5–8 line spec in plain English: what the app does, what the main screen looks like, and 3–4 features it needs
- ☐ Separate "must-have" from "nice-to-have" — there's only time for 3–4 features total
- ☐ Sketch the rough layout on paper or in a text file: header, main content area, buttons/forms

Phase 2 — Scaffold the app (0:25–0:40)

- ☐ Write the first prompt: state the app's purpose, the tech stack (plain HTML/CSS/JS), and the full feature list from the spec
- ☐ Ask for a working skeleton only — not a polished final product
- ☐ Paste the generated code in and get it running in the browser
- ☐ **Checkpoint:** does anything render? If not, copy the exact error message back to the AI before doing anything else

Phase 3 — Build, one feature at a time (0:40–1:30)

- ☐ Prompt for one must-have feature at a time — never "build the whole app" in one prompt
- ☐ Read each response before pasting it in — does the team actually understand what the code does?
- ☐ Test the feature in the browser immediately after adding it
- ☐ When something breaks, paste the exact error or describe the exact wrong behavior
- ☐ Repeat for each remaining must-have feature
- ☐ **Checkpoint at 1:10:** at least 2 features should be working — cut a feature rather than rushing all of them

Phase 4 — Test it like a stranger would (1:30–1:45)

- ☐ Click through every feature as if seeing the app for the first time
- ☐ Try to break it: empty inputs, extreme values, clicking things out of order
- ☐ For every bug found, write a precise prompt with exact reproduction steps

Phase 5 — Polish, reflect, and demo (1:45–2:00)

- ☐ One prompt for visual polish (spacing, colors, a font) — one pass only
- ☐ Scribe writes the 3–4 sentence reflection while it's fresh: what worked, what didn't, one thing to prompt differently next time
- ☐ Demo round: each team gets 90 seconds to show the app + name the feature they're proudest of, then 30 seconds for questions (2 min × 4 teams = 8 min)

Success criteria

- ☐ App loads with no console errors
- ☐ At least 3 working features from the original spec
- ☐ The team can explain what every prompt they used was trying to achieve
- ☐ Short written reflection submitted

Stretch goals (early finishers)

- ☐ Add one nice-to-have feature from the original list
- ☐ Ask the AI for basic responsive/mobile styling
- ☐ Deploy it live — GitHub Pages, Netlify Drop, or a StackBlitz share link